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June 22, 1970

INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

BINDER, LOOSE-LEAF: MULTIPLE RING TYPE

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by Standardization Division, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, Washington, D.C. 20406, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers multiple ring loose-leaf binders.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Type. Binders shall be of the following types, as specified (see 6.2).

Type I. 1/2 inch center-to-center ring spacing.
Type II. 9/16 inch center-to-center ring spacing.

1.2.2 Class. Binders shall be bound in covers in accordance with the following class designation, as specified (see 6.2).

Class 1. Clear vinyl with colored vinyl backbone.
Class 2. Vinyl reinforced with book cover board.
Class 3. Rubber bonded cellulose fiber (one-piece cover construction).
Class 4. High density polyethylene or polyallomer (one-piece cover construction).

1.2.3 Sheet size, capacity, and number of rings. Sheet size, capacity, and number of rings shall be as specified in the invitation for bids, contract, or order (see 6.2).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

UU-B-623 - Book Cover Board.
PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636 - Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-665 - Boxes, Paperboard, Metal Stayed (Including Stay Material).
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Set-up.

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C. 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Washington.

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Military Specification:

MIL-P-116 - Preservation, Method of.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specification procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) Publications:

ASTM D 256 - Impact Resistance of Plastics and Electrical Insulating Materials.
ASTM D 638 - Tensile Properties of Plastics.
ASTM D 746 - Brittleness Temperature of Plastics and Elastomers by Impact.
ASTM D 747 - Stiffness of Plastics by Means of a Cantilever Beam.
ASTM D 1004 - Tear Resistance of Plastic Film and Sheeting.
ASTM D 1238 - Measuring Flow Rates of Thermoplastics by Extrusion Plastometer.
ASTM D 1248 - Polyethylene Plastics Molding and Extrusion Materials.
ASTM D 1505 - Density of Plastics by the Density-Gradient Technique.
ASTM D 1525 - Vicat Softening Point of Plastics.
ASTM D 1822 - Tensile Impact Energy to Break Plastics and Electrical Insulating Materials.
ASTM E 18 - Rockwell Hardness and Rockwell Superficial Hardness of Metallic Materials.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania 19103).

Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry (TAPPI) Publications:

T404 - Tensile Breaking Strength of Paper and Paperboard.
T410 - Weight Per Unit Area (Basis Weight or Substance) of Paper and Paperboard.
T411 - Thickness (Caliper) of Paper and Paperboard.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, 360 Lexington Avenue, New York, New York 10017).

National Classification Board:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Association, Inc., Attention: Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, D.C. 20036).

Uniform Classification Committee:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, 202 Union Station, Chicago, Illinois 60606).

Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials.

3.1.1 Steel. The steel shall be of good quality, and all exposed steel surface shall have a smooth, bright, and corrosion resistant finish.

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3.1.1.1 Ring plates (arch frames) and rings (arches). Ring plates and rings shall be of cold-rolled steel having a hardness of RB 60-75.

3.1.1.2 Spring or tension plate (shield). The spring or tension plate shall be of cold-rolled steel having a hardness as follows:

0.011 inch thick and below - R15T 80-85
0.015 and 0.018 inch thick - R30T 56.5-67

3.1.1.3 Backplate. The backplate shall be of cold-rolled steel having a hardness of R30T 56.5-67.

3.1.1.4 If converted hardness numbers are reported, the original hardness test scale shall be indicated as in the following example.

B60 (from Rockwell 30T)

3.1.2 Cover material.

3.1.2.1 Vinyl, class 1 and 2 binders. Vinyl cover material for class 1 and 2 binders shall be polyvinyl chloride. Plasticizer shall be adequate to provide flexibility for resistance to drying and cracking to the finished vinyl when the binders are in use. The vinyl shall be nonmigratory and flexible, and shall have the physical characteristics shown in table I.

TABLE 1. Physical characteristics

Chracteristics	Thickness		
	0.014 inch	0.016 inch	0.040 inch
Tensile strength at yield, p.s.i., minimum	2300	2300	2200
Tear resistance, each direction, pounds, minimum	5.0	6.0	9.0
Cold crack (Masland impact) at -20° ± 2°F.	No evidence of cracking when tested as specified in 4.1.1.		
Resistance to weathering	No stiffening, cracking, crazing, discoloration, tackiness or exudation of plasticizer from the vinyl.		

3.1.2.2 Rubber bonded cellulose fiber, class 3 binders. Rubber bonded cellulose fiber cover material for class 3 binders shall be paper base made from cotton fibers, and beater impregnated with SRB rubber. The face side shall have a pyroxylin or vinyl coating, and when specified (see 6.2), material with a pyroxylin face coating shall be coated on the back side with pigment or pyroxylin as specified (see 6.3). The coating must be suitable for silk screening, stamping, or embossing. When tested in accordance with 4.1.1, the rubber bonded cellulose fiber shall meet the requirements specified in table II.

TABLE II. Rubber bonded cellulose fiber requirements

Requirements	Thickness	
	0.025-inch	0.030-inch
Basis Weight (24 inch, by 36 inch, 500 sheets)	315 ± 15 lbs.	355 ± 18 lbs.
Tensile Breaking Strength, Minimum		
Machine direction	160 lbs./in. of width	180 lbs./in. of width
Cross direction	50 lbs./in. of width	60 lbs./in. of width

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3.1.2.3 Polyethylene and polyallomer, class 4 binders. Unless designated (see 6.2), cover material for class 4 binders shall be antistatic high-density polyethylene, or polyallomer. The polyethylene shall meet the requirements of type III, class B, category 4 of ASTM D 1248. Polyallomer shall have the physical properties specified in table III. The plastic shall be uniform in thickness, and shall be free from streaks, blisters, scratches, and crazing. The plastic must be suitable for silk screening, stamping, or embossing.

TABLE III. Physical properties of polyallomer

Physical property	Range of values
Density, g/cc	0.895 - 0.900
Tensile strength at yield, psi	3050 - 3850
Stiffness in flexure, 10^5 psi	0.70 - 1.10
Tensile impact strength, ft.lb./in. of notch:	
Material 0.035 inch in thickness	100 minimum
Material 0.055 inch in thickness	75 minimum
Izod impact strength, 23° C., ft.lb./in. of notch	1.7C - 6.0P
Izod impact strength, ft.lb./in. of width, unnotched:	
at 23°C.	No break
at -18°C.	5C minimum
Brittleness temperature, °C.	-10 - -4C
Softening point, Vicat, °C.	120 minimum
Flow rate g/10 min. at 230°C. and 2.16 kg. load	1.0 - 3.0

3.1.2.4 Color and finish. The class 1 binder shall have clear, colorless, transparent covers, and unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), a blue backbone. The color of cover material for class 2, 3, and 4 binders shall be as specified in the invitation for bids, contract or order (see 6.2), and unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), shall have a simulated leather shallow grain. Special overtone or two tone finish of the class 3 cover material shall be specified in the invitation for bid, contract, or order (see 6.2).

3.1.3 Book cover board. The book cover board shall conform to the requirements of UU-B-623.

3.2 Design. The binders shall be designed to securely retain filler sheets when rings are closed and shall be such that one or more sheets can be inserted or removed without disturbing the remaining contents. Binders shall be designed so that sheets therein will present a flat writing surface for making entries when the binder is open. The binders shall be such that the back and binding mechanism, including the opening or closing levers, or device, at one or both ends of the binding mechanism, will not mar smooth surfaces such as desks, tables, and bookcase shelves.

3.3 Construction. Each binder shall consist of a multiple, flat ring binding mechanism (ring metals) bound into the back, and two covers. The class 1 and 2 binders shall have the two covers joined to the back by hinges as specified in 3.3.2.1 and 3.3.2.2, and the class 3 and 4 binders shall consist of one-piece covers with scored hinges. Rings shall have positive mating ends when closed through the provision of suitable key depressions or grooves. When mated, ends of rings shall meet smoothly to permit travel of pages back and forth without snagging. Spring or tension plate shall provide sufficient tension to insure rings being mated tightly when closed. Ring metals shall be constructed so that the rings can be opened by means of a lever, trigger, booster, or other device, at one or both end of the binder.

3.3.1 Binding mechanism (ring metals). The binding mechanism shall consist of two ring plates which shall carry the rings, a spring or tension plate, and the opening device(s). The binding mechanism may have a closing and locking device at the option of the manufacturer. The size of the binding mechanism shall be approximately the specified sheet size in length, and the width shall be controlled by the capacity of the binder in accordance with commercial practice.

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3.3.1.1 Ring plates (arch frames) and rings (arches). The ring plates and rings shall be made of steel specified in 3.1.1.1. The rings shall be flat in design with the type I 5/32 ± 1/16-inch wide, and the type II 7/32 ± 1/32-inch wide. Thickness of ring plates and rings shall be as follows:

Type I - Less than 1/2-inch capacity - not less than 0.040-inch.
1/2 through 1 inch capacity - not less than 0.045-inch.
Over 1 inch capacity - not less than 0.050-inch.
Type II - 1-1/8-inch and less capacity - not less than 0.036-inch.
Over 1-1/8 inch capacity - not less than 0.050-inch.

The ring plates shall completely fill the space in the spring or tension plate.

3.3.1.2 Spring or tension plate (shield). The spring or tension plate shall be made of steel specified in 3.1.1.2. Thickness of spring or tension plates shall be as follows:

Type I - Less than 1/2 inch capacity - not less than 0.006-inch.
1/2 through 1 inch capacity - not less than 0.010-inch.
Over 1 inch capacity - not less than 0.012-inch.
Type II - 1-1/8 inch and less capacity - not less than 0.015-inch.
Over 1-1/8 inch capacity - not less than 0.018-inch.

3.3.2 Covers.

3.3.2.1 Class 1 binders. Cover material for class 1 binders shall be vinyl specified in 3.1.2.1. The front and back cover shall be colorless and transparent, 0.040 ± 0.002-inch in thickness, and the backbone and hinge area shall be two pieces of colored vinyl (see 3.1.2.4), 0.014 ± 0.001-inch in thickness. The two pieces of colored vinyl shall be sealed along each edge (length dimension) of the backbone in a manner to provide housing for the backbone support and backplate, and to provide front and back cover hinges. Hinges shall be fashioned in such a manner that inserted sheets will present a smooth writing surface for making written entries when the binder is open. The colored vinyl strips shall extend beyond the area of the backbone to completely encompass the protruding rings, and the strips shall be connected to the transparent covers by sealing on the front and back. The entire outer edge of both covers of the finished binder shall have a beaded or smooth edge. All seams and welds shall be made by the high frequency electronic sealing method. Binder covers shall be sufficiently larger than the specified sheet size to protect them and index tabs extending up to 1/2-inch beyond the outer edge of the sheets. Outside corners of the binder shall be rounded.

3.3.2.2 Class 2 binders. Cover material for class 2 binders shall be vinyl specified in 3.1.2.1 over both sides of book cover board specified in 3.1.3. The grain of the book cover board shall run parallel to the top and bottom of the binder covers. The vinyl shall be 0.014 ± 0.001-inch, or 0.016 ± 0.001-inch in thickness, as specified (see 6.2). The vinyl shall overlap the book cover board to permit sealing, and shall encompass the backbone area to provide housing for the backbone support and backplate (when applicable), and to provide front and back cover hinges. The overlapped edges and area established for hinges shall be welded or sealed by the high frequency electronic method. The vinyl covering shall be fitted to the book cover board in such a manner that no wrinkling or loosening is evident when the binder is in the opened or closed position. Book cover board shall be 0.098-inch thick for binders up to 1-5/8 inch capacity, and 0.120-inch thick for binders over 1-5/8 inch capacity. Thickness tolerance for book cover board shall be in accordance with the material specification. Binder covers shall be sufficiently larger than the sheet size as specified in 3.3.2.1 and outside corners shall be rounded. When specified (see 6.2), the entire inner area of the hinges for the front and back cover shall be reinforced with vinyl-impregnated nylon cloth.

3.3.2.3 Class 3 and 4 binders. Cover material for class 3 and 4 binders shall be a single sheet of material specified in 3.1.2.2 or 3.1.2.3, as appropriate. The rubber bonded cellulose fiber used in the class 3 binder shall be 0.025 ± 0.002-inch in thickness for binders up to and including 1-1/2 inch capacity, and 0.030 ± 0.002-inch in thickness for binders over 1-1/2 inch capacity. The plastic used in the class 4 binder shall be 0.035 ± 0.002-inch in thickness for binders up to and including 1-1/2 inch capacity and 0.055 ± 0.002-inch in thickness for binders over 1-1/2 inch capacity. To establish a hinge area for the front and back cover, the limits of the backbone area shall be scored by a hot embossing processing. The scoring width between the front and back cover shall be not less than the specified capacity of the binder. The class 3 binder may, at the option of the manufacturer, have a narrow ridge embossed approximately 1/4-inch in from the outside edge, and continuing entirely around all outside edges. Binder covers shall be sufficiently larger than the sheet size as specified in 3.3.2.1 and outside corners shall be rounded.

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3.3.3 Backbone support (backplate).

3.3.3.1 Class 1 binders. The backbone support for the class 1 binders shall consist of a single steel plate not less than the length of the binding mechanism, or two plates each not less than 2 inches long, one covering each rivet area (see 3.1.1.3). The overall width of the steel plate(s) shall be not less than the specified capacity of the binder, and shall be not less than 0.016-inch thick. The steel plate(s) shall be backed on each side with strips of 0.050 ± 0.002-inch pasted chipboard with the grain running parallel to the top and bottom of the backbone. The board shall be sufficiently longer and wider than the steel plate(s) to protect the vinyl covering from wear or cutting by the steel. The board shall be secured to the steel plates.

3.3.3.2 Class 2 binders. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the backbone support for the class 2 binders shall be constructed as specified for class 1 binders (3.3.3.1). When specified (see 6.2), the backbone support will be without the steel plate(s) as specified in 3.3.3.1, and shall consist of only one thickness of pasted chipboard equal in thickness to the specified book cover board used in the cover construction.

3.3.3.3 Class 3 and 4 binders. When specified (see 6.2), the backbone support for the class 3 binders shall consist of a strip of pressboard, fiberboard, or rubber bonded cellulose fiber, not less than 0.025-inch thick and the length and width of the binding mechanism placed between the backbone and the binding mechanism. When specified (see 6.2), the support strip shall be extended on each side sufficiently beyond the outside rings and scored for ring protectors to prevent rings from wearing through the covers. Class 4 binders do not require a backbone support.

3.3.4 Assembly. The spring or tension plate containing the ring plates and rings, and the backbone support, when applicable (see 3.3.3), shall be attached to the backbone by not less than 2 metal rivets, either one-third tubular or solid, by means of turning over the ends of the rivets onto the front (inside) of the spring or tension plate. The class 1 binder, and the class 2 binder with backbone construction as specified for the class 1 binder, shall have concealed rivet heads (inserted so that the heads are on the outside of the backplate). The class 2 binder without a steel backplate and one thickness of chipboard, and the class 3 and 4 binders shall have the rivet heads on the outside of the backbone.

3.4 Sheet lifters. Sheet lifters shall be black and fabricated from pressboard, fiberboard, or plastic. A minimum of two sheet lifters shall be provided with each binder, size and thickness in accordance with normal commercial practice.

3.5 Title slot. A title slot, including inserts or title tabs, shall be fabricated in accordance with normal commercial practice or as described in the invitation for bids, and shall be of the size (dimensions)and located on the binder as specified (see 6.2). The title slot, when specified, shall be provided with a transparent plastic cover (window).

3.6 Performance. The loose-leaf binders shall be capable of opening and closing smoothly, the rings shall maintain correct alignment, and the mechanism shall operate without breakdown.

3.7 Exterior marking, lettering, or labeling of covers. The method, location, design, terminology, color, and durability of the marking, lettering, or labeling shall be as specified in the invitation for bids, or request for proposal (see 6.2).

3.8 Identification-of-product marking. The manufacturer's name or trademark, or both (both is at the option of the manufacturer), shall be printed, stamped, or silk screened on the inside of one cover of the binder.

3.9 Workmanship. The loose-leaf binders shall be well finished, clean, and all edges shall be smooth. All metal parts shall be free from burrs and rough or sharp edges. The binder covers shall be free from warpage, scratches, tears, punctures and other defects which affect the appearance or impair the serviceability of the binder. The hinge scoring depth on the class 3 and 4 binders shall be controlled so that covers will remain closed when the binder is in a flat position on a smooth surface such as a desk or table top.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

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4.1.1 Component testing of materials. The supplier is responsible for insuring that the following component materials were manufactured, examined, and tested in accordance with this specification or referenced subsidiary specifications or standards. Component testing shall represent materials received (or manufactured) by the supplier as a shipment at one time, of the same type and color, manufactured by the same source and essentially under the same conditions, and identified as used in the production of the quantity of the end items. Unless otherwise specified, the sample size shall be the sample unit specified in the applicable test method, selected at random within the shipment.

Vinyl. Vinyl used in fabricating class 1 and 2 binders shall be tested in accordance with the following American Society for Testing and Materials Test Methods to determine conformance with the requirements of table I (3.1.2.1).

Tensile strength at yield	D 638
Tear resistance	D 1004

Determination of conformance to cold crack requirements of table I shall be as follows:

Ten rectangular specimens 5-3/4 by 2 inches shall be cut in the cross grain direction, folded in half to form a loop and stapled to a stiff paper card. The specimens and an impact hammer shall be stored in a freezer for one hour at a temperature of -20° ± 2°F. At the end of one hour, one specimen at a time is placed on an anvil and the hammer is allowed to fall free through an angle of 85° and strike the specimen. Each individual specimen is considered to pass if it does not separate or shatter any place along the entire width upon impact. The sample of vinyl is considered to pass at the specified temperature if 8 of 10 individual specimens do not shatter or break.

Rubber bonded cellulose fiber. Rubber bonded cellulose fiber used in fabricating class 3 binders shall be tested in accordance with the following TAPPI Test Methods to determine conformance with the requirements of table II (3.1.2.2).

Basis weight	T410
Tensile breaking strength	T404
Thickness (caliper)	T411

Polyethylene. Polyethylene used in fabricating class 4 binders shall be tested in accordance with the requirements of ASTM D 1248 (3.1.2.3).

Polyallomer. Polyallomer used in fabricating class 4 binders shall be tested in accordance with the following American Society for Testing and Materials Test Methods to determine conformance with the requirements of table III (3.1.2.3).

Density	D 1505
Tensile strength at yield	D 638
Stiffness in flexure	D 747
Tensile impact strength	D 1822
Izod impact strength (Notched and Unnotched)	D 256
Brittleness temperature	D 746
Softening point, Vicat	D 1525
Flow rate	D 1238

Hardness and material thickness of steel. Hardness and material thickness of steel used in fabricating the binding mechanism and back plate shall be tested or inspected to determine conformance with the values specified in 3.1.1. Hardness of steel shall be determined in accordance with ASTM E 18.

4.1.1.1 Report of analysis. In lieu of using his own facilities, the supplier may submit a report of analysis of the component materials from a laboratory acceptable to the Government as evidence of compliance with the specification requirements. The supplier shall maintain records of component testing. These records shall be available to the authorized Government representative, and shall include: (1) the source, (2) date of receipt, (3) component material designation, (4) date of test(s), (5) test data, and (6) quantity of material represented by the test report. Each report of analysis must be within the period of the contract, or within 60 days prior to the commencement of the contract.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 Lot. A lot shall consist of all binders presented for inspection at one time as defined in MIL-STD-105.

4.2.2 Sampling of end item for visual and operational examination. A random sample of binders shall be taken from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level S-4. The acceptable quality level (AQL) shall not exceed 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one binder.

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4.2.3 Sampling for preparation for delivery requirements. For examination of interior packages the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery, and selected at random just prior to the closing operation. Closure defects shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end-item inspection lot. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level S-2. The acceptable quality level (AQL) shall not exceed 4.0 percent defective.

4.3 Examination.

4.3.1 Visual and operational examination of end item.

4.3.1.1 Visual examination. Samples taken in accordance with 4.2.2 shall be examined for defects listed in table IV. Any samples containing one or more defect shall be rejected. The Government reserves the right to classify as a defect any departure from the specification not listed in table IV.

TABLE IV. Classification of binder defects

Examine	Defects
Binder and Components	Binder not size, capacity, color, or finish specified. Any dimension not as specified. Design and construction not as specified. Covers, hinge scoring, and binding mechanism, as applicable, not as specified. Finish of exposed metal surface not smooth and bright. Sheet lifters missing or not as specified. Opening booster missing. Identification of product marking not as specified. Workmanship not as specified.

4.3.1.2 Operational examination. Samples taken in accordance with 4.2.2 shall be examined for defects involving operational performance of the binding mechanism as indicated in table V.

TABLE V. Operational examination

Examine	Defects
Binding mechanism-- The binder shall be opened and closed in the normal manner of operation. Repeat this operation 20 consecutive times.	Booster clips do not function properly, i.e., rings do not open. Rings do not open completely. Rings do not fit snugly or align properly in closed position; do not completely close.

4.3.2 Examination of preparation for delivery. Samples selected in accordance with 4.2.3 shall be examined to determine that the preservation, packaging, packing and marking requirements of section 5 of this specification are complied with. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table VI.

TABLE VI. Classification of preparation for delivery defects

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate stapling. Distortion of container.
Contents (exterior and interior container)	Number per container is more or less than required.

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5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. The binders in quantities as specified (see 6.2) shall be packaged in accordance with method IC-2 of MIL-P-116.

5.1.2 Level B. Four binders of one type and size, one inch capacity and over, or six binders of one type and size, less than one inch capacity, shall be packaged in a close-fitted box conforming to PPP-B-566, PPP-B-665, or PPP-B-676.

5.1.3 Level C. The Binders shall be packaged in accordance with the supplier's commercial practice.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Unit packages of binders, in quantities as specified (see 6.2), shall be packed in a close-fitted box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. The box shall be closed, waterproofed, and strapped in accordance with the appendix to PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Level B. Nine unit packages, of one type and size, one inch capacity and over (36 binders), or twenty-four unit packages, of one type and size, less than one inch capacity (144 binders), shall be packed in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to PPP-B-636.

5.2.3 Level C. The binders packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in containers to assure carrier acceptance and safe arrival at destination in compliance with Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification.

5.3 Marking. In addition to markings required by the contract or order (see 6.2), the interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123, or MIL-STD-129, as specified (see 6.2).

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The binders covered by this specification are intended for use in filing records, reports, and other papers when it is desirable that they can be readily inserted or removed.

6.2 Order data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents.

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Type and class binder required (see 1.2.1 and 1.2.2).
(c) Binder sheet size, capacity, and number of rings required (see 1.2.3).
(d) Back coating of class 3 binder, if desired (see 3.1.2.2 and 6.3).
(e) Specify plastic for the class 4 binder (polyethylene or polyallomer), if desired (see 3.1.2.3).
(f) Color for class 2, 3, and 4 binders. Color for class 1 binder, if other than blue is desired. Specify special grain or finish for class 3 binder, if desired (see 3.1.2.4).
(g) Class 2 binder. Designate thickness of vinyl cover material (0.014 or 0.016). Specify reinforced hinges, if desired (see 3.3.2.2).
(h) Class 2 binder. Specify when the backbone support requires pasted chipboard only (see 3.3.3.2).
(i) Class 3 binder. Specify whether to have backbone support, and whether backbone support is to be extended to provide ring protector strips (see 3.3.3.3).
(j) Whether title slots are required; include size and location (see 3.5).
(k) Exterior marking, lettering, or labeling of cover(s) (see 3.7).
(l) Quantity of binders required in unit package (level A packaging) (see 5.1.1).
(m) Quantity of binders required in shipping container (level A packing) (see 5.2.1).
(n) Selection of applicable level of packaging, packing and marking required (see 5.1, 5.2, and 5.3).
(o) Any special marking required (see 5.3).

6.3 Rubber bonded cellulose fiber (see 3.1.2.2) with pyroxylin face coating is not normally coated on the back side unless specified, and this back coating is offered in pigment or pyroxylin form at an extra charge. The back coating adds longevity to the cover material and is decorative, with the pyroxylin of a higher quality than the pigment coating.

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GENERAL SERVICES ADMINISTRATION - FEDERAL SUPPLY SERVICE

SPECIFICATION COMMENT SHEET

BUDGET BUREAU NO. 29-R0175

INSTRUCTIONS

This form provides a way for users of this specification to inform the originator of problems encountered in its use. It is not to be used to request changes to accommodate proprietary features. All comments will be considered and appreciated, but please do not expect a reply. To comment: detach, complete, and mail to: Gen. Services Admin, FSS (FMSO), Washington, D.C., 20406.

NOTE: Comments on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any part of the document or serve to amend contractual requirements.

1. SPECIFICATION UU-B-00344 (GSA-FSS)
Binder, Loose-Leaf: Multiple Ring Type

2. CONTRACT NO. *(If any)*	3. QUANTITY ON CONTRACT *(Optional)*	4. DOLLAR VALUE *(Optional)*

5. GENERAL NATURE OF PROBLEM *(e.g., inspection difficulties, manufacturers unable to meet tolerances, containers collapse under normal warehousing conditions, etc.)*

6. SPECIFIC REQUIREMENTS AFFECTED *(Include paragraph number and lines of wording)*

7. SPECIFIC PROBLEMS *(e.g. tests in 4.2.2 will not assure that the battery will last required time; temperature ranges in table 2 do not conform to commercially available items.)*

8. RECOMMENDATIONS

9. NAME OF MANUFACTURER, ASSOCIATION, GOVT., AGENCY, ETC.	10. ADDRESS *(Number, Street, City, State and Zip Code)*

11. NAME AND TITLE OF SUBMITTER	12. DATE

FORM GSA FSS 00 2200

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